

TRUSTLAYER FOUNDATION, A.C.

Governance Framework

& Internal Bylaws (Reglamento Interno)

Governing the ARIA Protocol, the UCDM Protocol, and all future open standards adopted by TLF

Version 1.5 · May 2026

Post-Consejo review, incorporating Secretario self-audit findings

Summary of changes from v1.4 to v1.5

§3.4.1 — New section: Asociado Admission Process with published criteria, multiple nomination channels, public comment period, and community-accountability cascade.

§4.3.1 — New section: TSC Phase 1 Appointment Process with objective criteria and community preview period.

§4.4 — Elected TSC Vice-Chair added with explicit authority to call formal votes when consensus determination is disputed.

§4.5.1 — New section: TSC Consensus Determination Protocol — written, auditable criteria for declaring rough consensus.

§7.6 — Amended to distinguish formal Community Group presence (governed by §7.8) from informal participation.

§7.8 — New section: Community Groups — TSC obligations toward CG Recommendations, four-tier specification change communication, Liaison Co-Chair with independence requirements.

§11.2 — Restructured: TUNO Labs relationship clarified as two distinct contracts — Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo (technology development) and ROLA (operator license, revenue share applied identically to all operators; specific rate established in ROLA template by month 18).

§1.6.3 — Cross-references to §3.4.1 and §4.3.1 added; ROLA timeline references aligned with new §11.2 architecture.

§13.9 — Maturity Report requirements expanded to include Asociado admission status and TSC composition status.

§2 — New definitions: Community Group, Liaison Co-Chair, Formal Recommendation, Acuerdo de Servicios. Cross-references added to Asociado, TSC, Affiliated Entity.

Deferred — Two improvements identified for v1.5.1 or v1.6: §5.3 zombie-foundation trigger via W3C CG declaration; §10.3 Formal Objection lightweight accountability process.

Acta Constitutiva: CUD A202603102338416405

Notaría Pública Interina No. 175, Naucalpan de Juárez · Lic. Javier Vázquez Mellado Mier y Terán

Open standards. Nonprofit governance. Trustworthy technology.

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On Language Used in This Document

This Framework is published in English. Certain terms appear in Spanish throughout, preserved verbatim from the Acta Constitutiva because they carry specific legal meaning under Mexican law that translation would lose.

Acta Constitutiva. The founding charter of TLF, filed with Notaría 175 Naucalpan and registered under CUD A202603102338416405.

Asamblea General. The Asamblea General de Asociados — the supreme governing body of TLF under the Acta and Mexican A.C. law.

Asociado. A formal member of the Asamblea General with voting rights, admitted per the Acta and per §3.4.1 of this Framework.

Consejo Directivo. The board of directors of TLF, established by the Acta.

Comisario. The independent oversight officer required under Mexican A.C. law.

CUD. Clave Única del Documento — the unique document identifier assigned by the Mexican Secretaría de Economía to the authorized denomination of TLF.

Voto de calidad. The tie-breaking vote granted by the Acta to the Presidente in case of equal votes; bounded by §3.1.2 and §3.4.

Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo. The technology development and operational services agreement between TLF and TUNO Labs, distinct from the ROLA. See §11.2 and §2 Definitions.

All other terminology in this Framework is in English. A Spanish translation of the Framework is in active progress per the Foundation's Localization commitments under §1.5.

1. Preamble & Mission

TrustLayer Foundation, A.C. ("TLF" or "the Foundation") is a Mexican Asociación Civil constituted on March 20, 2026, before Notaría Pública Interina No. 175 of the State of Mexico (Lic. Javier Vázquez Mellado Mier y Terán), residing in Naucalpan de Juárez, Estado de México, under Title Eleven, Chapter One of the Código Civil del Estado de México and its correlatives in the Código Civil para el Distrito Federal (now Ciudad de México) and the civil codes of the other federal entities of the United Mexican States. The Acta Constitutiva expressly references articles 7.771, 7.806, and 7.807 of the Código Civil del Estado de México and articles 2554 and 2587 of the Código Civil para el Distrito Federal as the basis for the powers of administration and representation conferred upon the Consejo Directivo. This Governance Framework and Internal Bylaws supplements the Foundation's Acta Constitutiva and governs all activities of the Foundation, its organs, working groups, affiliated entities, and the open standards under its mandate.

TLF exists to ensure that as digital infrastructure becomes more autonomous and interconnected, it remains accountable to the humans and institutions it serves. The Foundation operates as a nonprofit steward of open standards and verifiable trust frameworks, working across multiple domains where independent governance of technical specifications serves the public interest.

The Foundation currently stewards two protocols: the ARIA Protocol (Agent Registry for Identity & Authorization) and the UCDM Protocol (Universal Commerce Data Model). The Foundation may adopt additional standards, working groups, and initiatives over time. All such future protocols and initiatives, once formally adopted by the Consejo Directivo, shall be governed by this Framework.

Canonical sources: All TLF-stewarded specifications and corporate information are published at trustlayer.foundation. Specification-specific resources are published at their respective canonical URIs.

1.1 Animating Principles

The Foundation's work is guided by the following principles. These principles apply to TLF as an institution and inform all standards under its mandate:

- (a) Public-interest stewardship.** TLF stewards open standards in the public interest.
- (b) Openness.** All specifications, processes, meeting records, and decisions of the Foundation are publicly accessible.
- (c) Standards integration over competition.** TLF seeks to complement and interoperate with existing standards bodies — including IETF, W3C, NIST, ISO, OASIS, DIF, OpenID Foundation, ToIP, UN/CEFACT, GS1, and the European harmonized standards bodies (ETSI, CEN, CENELEC) — rather than create competing alternatives.
- (d) Nonprofit stewardship.** The Foundation is not operated for the private benefit of any individual, affiliated entity, or commercial interest.

(e) Federation over monopoly. Where TLF-stewarded standards involve operational infrastructure, TLF actively promotes a federation of independent operators implementing those standards.

(f) Responsibility toward the world. The Foundation operates informed by an ethical commitment to contribute to a world that is more accountable, more inclusive, and more repaired through the technology it builds.

1.2 Constitutional Anchor — Open Access Principle

Per Acta Artículo Quinto, the Foundation operates under a constitutionally mandated principle of open and free access. This Acta provision has constitutional weight within TLF and supersedes any later provision that would contradict it.

1.3 Objeto Social Alignment

This Framework operationalizes the nine fracciones of TLF's objeto social as constituted in the Acta Constitutiva, Artículo Cuarto: (I) conscious, responsible, and ethical use of technology; (II) governance of open standards as a nonprofit independent entity; (III) identity and authorization standards for software and AI agents, including but not limited to the ARIA Protocol; (IV) verifiable commercial data standards, including but not limited to the UCDM standard; (V) coordination with international standards bodies including W3C, IETF, NIST, DIF, OpenID Foundation, ToIP, ICANN, and other relevant organizations; (VI) non-discriminatory licensing to commercial entities; (VII) scientific research, technological development, and education; (VIII) publication, dissemination, and communication; (IX) community, participatory governance, and contribution to global standards through community development.

1.4 Future Standards and Initiatives

Any new standard, protocol, working group, or initiative formally adopted by the Consejo Directivo under TLF's mandate shall, upon adoption, be governed by this Framework.

1.5 Localization

The official languages of the Foundation are Spanish (es-MX) and English (en-US), per IETF BCP 47 language tags. The Acta Constitutiva is in Spanish and controls in case of any conflict between language versions. A Spanish translation of this Framework is in active progress per the Foundation's open commitments (see Open Decisions sidepage).

1.6 Foundation Maturity Roadmap

This Framework is published in the Foundation's first year of operation. The Foundation states clearly here both what it is today and what it is becoming.

The roadmap operates on two axes that evolve independently but in coordination:

- Axis 1 — **Asamblea growth** via Asociado admissions, operationalized in §3.4.1.
- Axis 2 — **Consejo expansion** via Asamblea designation per Acta Transitorio Primero (up to nine members).

The following matrix documents the Foundation's commitments across five phases. Approval of this matrix by the Consejo Directivo elevates it from Founder proposal to institutional policy.

Phase / Months	Asamblea General	Consejo Directivo	TSC	Membership
Phase 0 — Today (month 0)	4 founding Asociados. Admission process per §3.4.1.	4 founding Consejo members. Acta permits expansion up to 9.	Founder appointment in progress per §4.3.1. Aaron as TSC Chair (Founding Stage).	§12 establishes the framework; tier activation pending Consejo decision.
Phase 1 — Months 0 to 12	Admission of at least three (3) external Asociados (non-founders) per §3.4.1 and §1.6.3.	Remains at 4. Possible addition of one external Consejo member.	Phase 1 founder appointments completed per §4.3.1 (4 seats). Vice-Chair elected per §4.4.	Contributor tier operational. Possible activation of Individual tier.
Phase 2 — Months 12 to 18	7 to 9 Asociados. Mix of founders and externals.	First external Consejo additions (1 to 2 new members).	Phase 2 community election (three additional seats) held.	Corporate tier activated (if tiered model adopted).
Phase 3 — Months 18 to 24	10 to 15 Asociados. Founders are numerically a minority.	Consejo expanded toward 9 members per Acta.	All 7 TSC seats filled. Annual Chair election prepared.	All tiers operational. Donataria Autorizada application Q1 2027.
Steady state — Month 24+	Autonomous Asamblea. Ongoing admissions through §3.4.1.	Expanded Consejo in steady-state operation.	Annual TSC Chair elections from any member.	Federation of operators. Revenue mix: membership + operator revenue share + grants.

1.6.1 Founding Stage (months 0 through 24)

During the Founding Stage, TLF operates as a founder-led nonprofit stewarding the ARIA Protocol and incubating additional standards. This is honest founding reality, transparently disclosed.

1.6.2 Maturity Stage (month 24 and beyond)

Beginning at month 24, the Foundation operates under steady-state governance per the matrix above.

1.6.3 Commitments during the Founding Stage

The Foundation commits to the operational milestones in the matrix above. In summary form:

- Admission of at least three (3) external Asociados (non-founders) to the Asamblea General within twelve (12) months of constitution, per the process established in §3.4.1. Non-compliance procedures are specified in §3.4.1(e).
- The Consejo Directivo will actively pursue expansion to up to nine (9) members within twenty-four (24) months, per the commitment expressed in Acta Transitorio Primero.
- Completion of the TSC Phase 1 appointments per §4.3.1 by month 12, and Phase 2 community-elected seats by month 24, per §4.3.
- Formalization of the Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo between TLF and TUNO Labs as a priority operational deliverable in Q2-Q3 2026, per §11.2.A.
- Drafting of the Registry Operator License Agreement (ROLA) template by month 18 to allow signature of the ROLA with TUNO Labs and the onboarding of additional operators thereafter, per §11.2.B.
- Application for Donataria Autorizada status in Q1 2027, subject to satisfaction of statutory requirements (§3.7).
- Annual financial summary and governance maturity report published per §13.

1.6.4 What this Foundation is, and what it is becoming

The Foundation today is operated as a vehicle for stewarding the ARIA Protocol, with the legal and institutional form of a foundation. The Foundation tomorrow — by month 24 and beyond — is intended to operate as a foundation in itself, with multiple stewarded standards, an independent Asamblea, an expanded Consejo, an elected TSC, and a federation of operators. Both states are honest. The path between them is the matrix above.

1.7 Jurisdictional Positioning

The Foundation is constituted in Mexico. We operate from a country with a humanist tradition, historically neutral in international affairs, and we welcome collaboration with the world. The Foundation operates from here to contribute globally — recognizing that digital trust infrastructure benefits from voices and institutions across all regions, with particular emphasis on perspectives historically underrepresented in standards governance.

The Foundation engages qualified counsel and standards-body relationships in the jurisdictions where TLF-stewarded standards operate, including Mexico, the United States, the European Union, and other regions where adoption requires such engagement. TLF acknowledges that operators of TLF-stewarded standards are subject to the regulatory regimes of the jurisdictions in which they operate; the Foundation itself, as a Mexican Asociación Civil, is governed by Mexican law and does not directly process personal data of foreign subjects in the ordinary course of operations (see §15).

2. Definitions

In this document, the key words "MUST", "MUST NOT", "REQUIRED", "SHALL", "SHALL NOT", "SHOULD", "SHOULD NOT", "RECOMMENDED", "MAY", and "OPTIONAL" are to be interpreted as described in IETF RFC 2119 and RFC 8174.

Term	Definition
Acta Constitutiva	The founding charter of TLF as filed with the Notaría and registered under CUD (Clave Única del Documento) A202603102338416405.
Active Working Group Participant	An individual or entity that has attended three (3) or more WG or CG meetings within a rolling twelve-month period, or has submitted substantive technical input to the WG or CG record, regardless of whether they have submitted a formal Contribution under the IPR Policy. Active Participants are subject to the patent provisions of §8.4 and §8.7.
Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo	The technology development and operational services agreement between TLF and TUNO Labs, governing the development of the registry infrastructure, SDKs, resolver, and related technology. Distinct from the ROLA. See §11.2.A.
Affiliated Entity	Any legal entity in which one or more Consejo members hold a material commercial interest, where such entity has actual or potential commercial interaction with TLF or any standard or initiative under TLF's mandate. Includes (without limitation) TUNO Labs and Punto 2012.
ARIA	Agent Registry for Identity & Authorization — a protocol for cryptographically verifiable AI agent identity, stewarded by TLF, with canonical specification published at aria.bar .
Asamblea General	The Asamblea General de Asociados, the supreme governing body of TLF per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto. Admission process for new Asociados specified in §3.4.1.
Asociado	A formal member of the Asamblea General with voting rights, admitted per the Acta and per the admission process of §3.4.1. The four founders are the initial Asociados. Distinct from a 'Member' under §12.
Canonical Specification	The current published version of any TLF-stewarded standard at its official URI.
Comisario	The independent oversight officer required under Mexican A.C. law, designated per Acta Transitorio Segundo.
Community Group (CG)	An external open-participation forum, typically hosted at W3C or an equivalent standards body, that explores, incubates, and provides community input on topics relevant to TLF-stewarded specifications. Community Groups are advisory by nature: they do not have normative authority over TLF specifications. See §7.8.

Term	Definition
Consejo Directivo	The Foundation's Board of Directors as constituted in the Acta Constitutiva, Artículo Décimo Séptimo.
Contribution	Any work of authorship submitted to a TLF Working Group, including specification text, code, documentation, or test suites.
Contributor	Any individual or entity that has agreed to the IPR Policy and submitted a Contribution.
DCO	Developer Certificate of Origin v1.1 — a lightweight per-commit attestation that the contributor has the right to submit their contribution under the project's license.
CLA	Contributor License Agreement — a formal written agreement between a contributor and the Foundation, executed once and covering all subsequent contributions to a specified scope.
Editor	The individual designated by a Working Group as responsible for maintaining the canonical text of a specification, integrating Contributions, and coordinating release schedules with operators. The Editor has no normative authority but holds editorial discretion. See §7.7.
Federation	The set of independent operators implementing TLF-stewarded specifications under a Registry Operator License Agreement (ROLA) or equivalent.
Formal Recommendation	A documented position adopted by rough consensus of a Community Group and submitted to the TSC for formal response per §7.8.2. Formal Recommendations are the principal mechanism by which a CG provides input to TLF specification governance.
Hotfix	An emergency specification amendment approved under §9.3, published with version format MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH-hotfix.N, carrying full normative weight immediately upon publication and subject to retroactive review per §9.3(d). See §9.4.
IPR Policy	The Intellectual Property Rights Policy governing contributions to TLF specifications (Section 8).
Lazy Consensus	A decision-making process where silence indicates consent.
Liaison Co-Chair	A standing officer of a Community Group whose responsibility is to coordinate between the CG and the TSC. The Liaison Co-Chair must satisfy the eligibility and structural-independence requirements of §7.8.4.
Normative	Requirements that implementers MUST follow to claim conformance with a TLF specification.

Term	Definition
Principal	A human or legal entity that authorizes a software agent to act on their behalf, as defined in the relevant TLF specification.
ROLA	Registry Operator License Agreement — the standard license under which any qualified registry operator implements a TLF-stewarded standard. The ROLA template is published at trustlayer.foundation/rola and is substantially equivalent for all operators. See §11.2.B.
Rough Consensus	A decision-making process, per IETF RFC 7282, where the chair determines that the group has addressed all substantive concerns. Determination methodology for TLF specified in §4.5.1.
Specification	A normative document published by TLF defining the requirements of a protocol or framework.
TSC	Technical Steering Committee — the body with technical decision-making authority over TLF-stewarded specifications. Appointment process specified in §4.3.1.
TUNO Labs	TUNO Labs, S.A.P.I. de C.V. — a Mexican Sociedad Anónima Promotora de Inversión, commercial entity affiliated with TLF founders, operating as a sibling entity (not subsidiary) to TLF.
UCDM	Universal Commerce Data Model — a TLF-stewarded standard for verifiable commercial data, currently in pre-publication phase.
Working Group (WG)	A chartered group of Contributors working on a specific specification or deliverable under TSC oversight.

3. Organizational Structure

3.1 Consejo Directivo

Per Acta Artículo Décimo Séptimo, the Consejo Directivo is composed of at least three (3) members designated by the Asamblea General. The Consejo currently consists of four (4) members and may expand up to nine (9) members per Acta Transitorio Primero. Members serve renewable three-year terms; per Acta Artículo Décimo Séptimo (I), members continue in office until successors are designated and take possession.

Role	Name	Function
Presidente (+ voto de calidad)	Aaron Adolfo Grego Rell	Strategic direction. Standards liaison. Tie-breaking vote per Acta Artículo Décimo Séptimo (II), bounded by §3.1.2.
Secretario	Adolfo Grego Micha	Legal and administrative coordination. CLUNI compliance. Document custody. Per Acta Artículo Décimo Noveno.
Vocal	Iván Moreno Mendoza	CTO. Technical architecture. Implementation oversight. Per Acta Transitorio Primero, Vocal authority is limited to acts of administration.
Tesorero	Carlos Grego Samra	Financial oversight. Patrimonio management. Fiscal compliance. Per Acta Artículo Vigésimo.

3.1.1 Powers of the Consejo

Per Acta Artículo Décimo Séptimo (III), the Consejo Directivo has the broadest powers for the management of the Foundation's activities, including (without limitation): (a) execution of the annual budget approved by the Asamblea General; (b) appointment and removal of Officers; (c) creation, modification, and dissolution of Working Groups upon TSC recommendation; (d) approval of Affiliated Entity agreements; (e) amendment of these Bylaws per Section 14; (f) strategic partnerships and institutional relationships; (g) delegation of specific authorities to Officers or committees.

Per Acta Transitorio Primero, acts of dominion require the joint signature of at least three (3) Consejo members. All other powers may be exercised jointly or separately as the Consejo determines.

3.1.2 Meetings, Quorum, and Voto de Calidad

Per Acta Artículo Décimo Séptimo (II), the Consejo Directivo meets at least once per calendar month. Meetings may be conducted in person, by video conference, or asynchronously by written or electronic resolution circulated to all members. Substantive deliberation meetings typically occur quarterly, with intervening monthly meetings serving as status reviews where major decisions are not required. Each meeting requires written minutes signed by the Presidente.

Per the Acta, statutory quorum is two (2) members. This Framework adopts the more conservative standard of a simple majority of current members for quorum on substantive matters. Decisions are made by simple majority of those present, except where a Supermajority is required by these Bylaws.

Voto de calidad. The Presidente's voto de calidad (tie-breaking vote) per Acta Artículo Décimo Séptimo (II) applies only to genuine ties. It does not extend to procedural matters or to matters from which the Presidente is recused under §6. The Presidente recuses from any vote concerning his own selection, removal, compensation, or any matter in which he holds a material conflict of interest under §6. Each exercise of the voto de calidad is recorded with specific notation in the meeting minutes and the public record per §13.

3.1.3 Supermajority Requirements

The following actions require a Supermajority of the Consejo (at least three of four current members, or two-thirds of current members if the Consejo is expanded): (a) amendment of these Bylaws; (b) modification or waiver of the Anti-Capture Provisions (Section 5); (c) removal of a TSC member; (d) approval of any Affiliated Entity agreement exceeding USD \$100,000 (or equivalent in MXN at official Banxico rate) or five (5) years in duration; (e) any change to the licensing terms of a published specification. Dissolution of the Foundation requires the qualified majority of the Asamblea General per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (XVI).

3.1.4 Founding-Stage Composition Disclosure

At the time of TLF constitution, the four Consejo members are also the four founding Asociados of the Asamblea General. This is honest founding reality. The Maturity Roadmap (§1.6) describes the bounded path by which both bodies expand to include external Asociados per §3.4.1 and external Consejo members.

3.2 Comisario

Per Acta Transitorio Segundo and Acta Artículo Vigésimo Primero, the Comisario is the independent oversight officer required under Mexican A.C. law. The current Comisario is Moises Shehoah Chiver. The Comisario shall: (a) review and certify annual financial statements; (b) ensure Consejo compliance with the Acta Constitutiva and these Bylaws; (c) report annually to the Asamblea General; (d) have unrestricted access to all Foundation records, while maintaining confidentiality per Acta Artículo Vigésimo Cuarto. The Comisario also holds statutory authority to convene an extraordinary Asamblea General in case of governance omission pursuant to Acta Artículo Vigésimo Tercero (VI); this authority is referenced in the community-accountability provisions of §3.4.1(e).

The Comisario is not a member of the Consejo, an employee of TLF, or an employee or officer of any Affiliated Entity.

3.3 Officers and Compensation

The Consejo may appoint Officers to manage specific operational areas. Officers serve at the discretion of the Consejo. Compensation of Consejo members and Officers, when applicable, is approved by Consejo Supermajority with recusal of the affected member, and disclosed in summary form in the annual financial summary per §13.4.

3.4 Asamblea General

Per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto, the Asamblea General de Asociados is the Órgano Directivo Supremo of the Foundation. The Asamblea meets at least once per year, within the first three months of each year, and in extraordinary session when convened by the Consejo Directivo, by the Comisario per Acta Artículo Vigésimo Tercero (VI), or when requested by at least 25% of Asociados.

Powers. Per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto, the Asamblea: (I) reviews Mesa Directiva and Tesorería reports; (II) approves financial statements per the Tesorería report; (III) approves budgets; (IV) approves annual work programs; (V) admits, suspends, and excludes Asociados — operationalized through the admission process of §3.4.1; (VI) sets dues; (VII) modifies the Acta Constitutiva; (VIII) reforms these Bylaws; (IX) approves acts of dominion over real property; (X) dissolves and liquidates the Foundation; (XVI) acts requiring qualified majority including Estatuto modification, dissolution, and acts of dominion over real property; (XVII) approves substantive amendments to TLF-stewarded specifications and standards; (XVIII) confers the Presidente's voto de calidad in case of tied votes; (XX, primer párrafo) creates, modifies, and dissolves working groups and technical committees; (XX, segundo párrafo) annual public declaration of transparency.

Founding-Stage composition. At the time of TLF constitution, the Asamblea consists of the four founding Asociados. The Foundation commits to admitting at least three (3) additional independent Asociados within twelve (12) months of constitution per §1.6.3 and §3.4.1. Membership tiers under §12 are a recruitment pipeline for Asociado candidacy; Membership status does not automatically confer Asociado voting rights.

3.4.1 Asociado Admission Process

Per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (V), the Asamblea General has exclusive authority to admit Asociados. This section establishes the operational process by which the Asamblea exercises that authority, designed to provide community accountability beyond founder discretion.

(a) Published criteria. A candidate for Asociado must satisfy all of the following:

- (i)** No current employment, board membership, equity holding, or compensated advisory relationship with any Affiliated Entity (per §2) — and no such relationship within the prior twenty-four (24) months;
- (ii)** No family relationship (per §6.2 definition) with any current Asociado;
- (iii)** Demonstrated seriousness, capacity, and good standing in the candidate's professional or civic life, evidenced by a sustained public record of accomplishment, recognized role, or institutional engagement

of at least five (5) years in a domain that the candidate can credibly relate to TLF's mission of trustworthy technology;

(iv) Demonstrated commitment to TLF's mission as stated in §1.1, evidenced by a written statement of interest published with their nomination, explaining how the candidate's background and perspective contribute to the Foundation's mission of stewarding trustworthy open standards;

(v) Stated availability to attend at least one (1) Asamblea per year and respond to written resolutions circulated to Asociados.

The Asamblea MAY admit a candidate only if all five criteria are met. The Asamblea MAY decline to admit a candidate who meets all five criteria only by published written rationale entered into the public record per §13.

(b) Nomination authority. A candidate is formally nominated by one of the following:

(i) Any current Asociado;

(ii) Any current TSC member (once the TSC is constituted);

(iii) Any Member of TLF in good standing for at least two (2) years (this mechanism activates at month 24+);

(iv) A petition signed by two (2) or more Contributors with at least one (1) accepted Contribution to a TLF-stewarded specification;

(v) Self-nomination by the candidate, accompanied by endorsement of at least one (1) current Asociado or TSC member.

Nominations are submitted to asociados@trustlayer.foundation with the candidate's statement of interest, professional history, and conflict disclosure.

(c) Public comment period. Each nomination is published on the TLF website with a thirty (30) calendar day public comment period. Community comments are reviewed by the Secretario and presented to the Asamblea before the vote.

(d) Asamblea vote. Per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (XV), admission requires simple majority of those present. The vote takes place no earlier than fifteen (15) days after the close of the public comment period. Each vote is recorded individually in the meeting minutes with rationale where the vote is contested.

(e) Non-compliance and community accountability. If the §1.6.3 commitment to admit three (3) external Asociados by March 20, 2027 is not met:

(i) Within thirty (30) days of the deadline, the Consejo Directivo publishes a written explanation at trustlayer.foundation/maturity-status, with named impediments. The revised timeline is set by the TSC, not the Consejo, providing an independent check on the bodies that did not deliver against the original commitment;

(ii) The explanation is communicated by written notice to the W3C Agent Identity Community Group (per §7.8), the TSC, and all current Contributors;

(iii) The annual Maturity Report (§13.9) dedicates a section to the delay, with causes, mitigations, and revised commitments;

(iv) If a revised deadline is also not met, the Comisario shall, pursuant to Acta Artículo Vigésimo Tercero (VI), convene an extraordinary Asamblea General to review the Foundation's progress against §1.6 commitments and propose remediation. The Comisario's authority to convene the Asamblea in case of governance omission is statutory and is exercised independently of the Consejo.

The Foundation acknowledges that these provisions create community accountability rather than legal enforcement. For a standards body, community accountability is the appropriate mechanism.

3.5 Organizational Structure — Parallel Authorities

TLF governance is structured as two parallel authorities reporting to a single supreme body. This is not a strict top-down hierarchy: the Consejo and the TSC are co-equal within their respective domains, both ultimately accountable to the Asamblea General.

Asamblea General de Asociados (supreme governing body per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto) — exercises ultimate authority over Acta modification, dissolution, Asociado admission per §3.4.1, and approval of substantive amendments to TLF-stewarded specifications per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (XVII).

Two parallel authorities under the Asamblea:

- **Consejo Directivo** — governance authority: organizational, financial, strategic, contractual, and institutional matters.
- **Technical Steering Committee (TSC)** — technical authority: specification content, working group oversight, and technical decision-making. Constituted per §4 of this Framework.

Neither body overrides the other within its respective domain.

3.6 External Counsel

The Foundation maintains an ongoing relationship with external counsel for international, intellectual property, and registry-law matters. Mike Rodenbaugh of Rodenbaugh Law serves as external counsel of record on such matters. Engagement of dedicated Mexican corporate counsel for domestic corporate, tax, and regulatory matters is in active progress; status is reported in the Open Decisions sidepage.

3.7 Donataria Autorizada Strategy

The Foundation intends to apply for Donataria Autorizada status when statutory requirements are satisfied, anticipated Q1 2027 per Acta Transitorio Primero.

4. Technical Steering Committee (TSC)

4.1 Purpose

The TSC is the body with technical decision-making authority regarding the content, direction, and release of all TLF-stewarded specifications. The TSC's role is oversight of the specification process, not direct code development. Its structure and decision-making model are informed by the Apache Software Foundation's PMC structure and the IETF's rough consensus model (IETF RFC 7282).

4.2 Composition

The TSC consists of seven (7) members composed as follows:

- (a) Three (3) seats:** civil society, academia, or independent researchers.
- (b) Two (2) seats:** industry representatives.
- (c) One (1) seat:** government or regulatory liaison.
- (d) One (1) seat:** developing-nation representative.

4.2.1 Family and Affiliated Entity Restrictions

To ensure the TSC remains structurally independent of the Foundation's founders and any single commercial interest:

- (a) Family restriction.** No two members of the same immediate or extended family may simultaneously serve on the TSC. During the Founding Stage, the Chair (Aaron Adolfo Grego Rell) is the sole representative of the founding family on the TSC.
- (b) Consejo / TSC dual-seat restriction.** No more than one (1) member of the Consejo Directivo may simultaneously serve on the TSC. (Note: Working Group Chair is not a TSC seat. The Vocal may chair Working Groups without holding a TSC seat.)
- (c) Affiliated Entity restriction.** No more than two (2) TSC members may have a substantial relationship with the same Affiliated Entity at the same time.
- (d) Geographic and sectoral diversity.** The TSC Chair endeavors to maintain diversity across geography, sector, gender, and professional background.

4.3 Founding Stage and Phase 2 Election

For purposes of this Section, the 'Founding Stage' refers specifically to the TSC. The Consejo Directivo's founding period is governed separately by Acta Transitorio Primero. Both periods coincide at twenty-four (24) months from TLF constitution by design.

Phase 1 — Founder appointment (months 0–12). The Founder appoints four (4) initial TSC members per the process specified in §4.3.1, ensuring at minimum one (1) from civil society or academia and one (1) from industry, per §4.2(a)–(d).

Phase 2 — Community election (months 12–24). The remaining three (3) seats are filled by community election. All Contributors who have made at least one (1) accepted Contribution to any TLF specification are eligible to vote. Election uses ranked-choice voting.

Phase 3 — Steady state (month 24+). All seven seats are filled. Annual elections fill expiring seats. Terms are three years, staggered.

4.3.1 TSC Phase 1 Appointment Process

Phase 1 appointments to the TSC are made by the Founder per §4.3, subject to the criteria and process specified in this section, designed to provide community visibility and structural accountability.

(a) Published criteria. A candidate for Phase 1 TSC appointment must satisfy all of the following:

(i) Composition fit. The candidate fills one of the four seat categories specified in §4.2: civil society/academia, industry, government/regulatory, or developing-nation representative.

(ii) Independence from Affiliated Entities. No employment, board membership, equity holding, or compensated advisory relationship with TUNO Labs, Punto 2012, or any other Affiliated Entity (per §2) within the prior twelve (12) months. This independence requirement is structural, not merely formal: the candidate must be in a position to vote against the Founder on a material matter without commercial consequence.

(iii) No family relationship. Per §4.2.1(a), no family relationship with the Founder or other Consejo members.

(iv) Demonstrated standing. Sustained public record of accomplishment, recognized role, or institutional engagement of at least five (5) years in a domain that the candidate can credibly relate to TLF's mission. Recognized roles in adjacent standards bodies (W3C, IETF, DIF, OpenID Foundation, NIST, ITU-T, ToIP, UN/CEFACT) are explicitly relevant but not required; equivalent standing in academic, civil-society, regulatory, or industry contexts qualifies.

(v) Willingness and capacity. Stated availability to attend TSC sessions at least quarterly during the Founding Stage and to serve a three-year term per §4.3.

(b) Community preview period. Before making Phase 1 appointments, the Founder publishes a candidate shortlist to the W3C Agent Identity Community Group mailing list (and equivalent public forums as appropriate) for a fourteen (14) calendar day comment period. The shortlist includes:

(i) The composition profile of each prospective seat (the seat category per §4.2 and the rationale for the candidate selection criteria);

(ii) Either the names of specific candidates or the profile criteria the Founder intends to apply, at the Founder's discretion;

(iii) The mechanism by which Community members may flag concerns to the Founder.

Community comments are reviewed by the Founder in good faith. The Founder is not bound by community comments but must respond in writing to substantive concerns and document the response in the public record per §13.

(c) Independent advisory review (optional). As an alternative or supplement to (b), the Founder may invite an independent advisory reviewer — an established participant in an adjacent standards body such as W3C, IETF, DIF, or OpenID Foundation — to review the Phase 1 shortlist and provide written feedback. The advisory reviewer holds no veto authority; their feedback is published in the public record alongside the appointment decision.

(d) Documentation of decisions. Each Phase 1 appointment is documented in the public record per §13 with: the seat category filled; the candidate's published statement of interest; the community comments received and the Founder's response; and any independent advisory feedback received.

(e) Community accountability. If Phase 1 TSC appointments are not substantially completed (defined as at least three of the four founder seats filled) within twelve (12) months of TLF constitution, the community-accountability cascade of §3.4.1(e) applies by analogy: the Consejo publishes a written explanation, the TSC sets the revised timeline, and the Comisario may convene an extraordinary Asamblea if a revised deadline is also not met.

4.4 TSC Chair and Vice-Chair

During the Founding Stage (months 0–24), Aaron Adolfo Grego Rell, the founder of the Foundation, serves as initial TSC Chair by founder prerogative. This is acknowledged as a founder-led arrangement, transparently disclosed.

(a) Steady-state Chair selection. From month 24 onward, the TSC Chair is elected annually by simple majority of the TSC from among its current members. There is no permanent Chair role.

(b) Single vote. The Chair carries the same single vote as any other TSC member, including during the Founding Stage.

(c) Acting Chair. If the Chair is unavailable or recused, the TSC elects an acting chair for that meeting.

(d) Removal. The Chair may be removed by: (i) voluntary resignation; (ii) death or permanent incapacity; or (iii) joint Supermajority vote requiring both Consejo Directivo Supermajority and TSC Supermajority, with cause documented in the public record.

(e) Recusal on self. The Chair recuses from any vote concerning his own selection, removal, compensation, or any matter in which he holds a material conflict of interest.

(f) Elected TSC Vice-Chair. Beginning with the constitution of the TSC, the TSC elects from among its members a Vice-Chair by simple majority. The Vice-Chair role is independent of the Chair role and is intended as a structural check on Chair authority. Specifically:

(i) Election independent of Chair. The Vice-Chair is elected by the TSC, not appointed by the Chair. The Founder, while serving as Founding-Stage TSC Chair, MAY stand for nomination as Vice-Chair only if no other qualified candidate is willing to serve; in such case the Vice-Chair role lapses and the Chair's authority is checked by the §4.5.1 protocol alone until a non-Chair Vice-Chair is elected.

(ii) Authority to call formal votes. The Vice-Chair has explicit authority to call for a formal vote of the TSC on any substantive matter when the Vice-Chair believes the Chair has incorrectly determined consensus, has unduly delayed a vote, or has framed an issue in a manner that prevents proper consideration. The Chair MUST honor such a call; the formal vote proceeds per §4.5 and the result is documented in the public record per §13.

(iii) Tie-breaking does not apply. The Vice-Chair does not hold tie-breaking authority. Tie-breaking on TSC matters follows §4.5.

(iv) Term and removal. The Vice-Chair serves a one-year term, renewable. Removal follows the same procedure as Chair removal per §4.4(d), substituting Vice-Chair for Chair.

(v) Family and independence restrictions. The Vice-Chair MUST satisfy §4.2.1 restrictions. In addition, the Vice-Chair MUST NOT be a member of the founding family or hold a substantial relationship with any single Affiliated Entity; this is a stronger requirement than §4.2.1(c) and is intended to ensure that the Vice-Chair functions as an independent check on Chair authority.

4.5 Decision-Making

The TSC operates by Rough Consensus as defined in IETF RFC 7282 and operationalized in §4.5.1. The Chair determines whether consensus has been reached. When consensus cannot be reached, the TSC may call a formal vote requiring a simple majority of TSC members. Each TSC member has one vote. The Chair breaks ties only when strictly necessary and documents the reasoning.

Lazy Consensus applies to non-controversial matters: if a proposal is posted to the TSC mailing list and no objections are raised within seven (7) calendar days, the proposal is approved. Any TSC member, including the Vice-Chair acting under §4.4(f)(ii), may request escalation to a formal discussion or vote.

Vocal participation. The Vocal of the Consejo Directivo (CTO of TLF) participates in TSC sessions with voice and consultative vote regardless of TSC membership status, when the agenda includes matters of implementation feasibility, operational impact on TLF-stewarded standards, or emergency security amendments under §9.3.

4.5.1 Consensus Determination Protocol

Rough consensus per IETF RFC 7282 is the foundation of TSC decision-making. To make consensus determination auditable and to prevent ambiguity in the framing of decisions, the following protocol applies in TLF's TSC:

(a) Proposal posted to the record. Substantive matters before the TSC are posted to the TSC public record (mailing list and public repository per §13.2(b)) in written form before deliberation begins. The

proposal identifies: the question to be decided; the options under consideration; the implementation impact assessment (informed by the Vocal where relevant); and any prior CG Recommendations bearing on the matter (per §7.8.2).

(b) Deliberation with documented concerns. During deliberation, all substantive concerns raised by TSC members or by participants per §4.5 (Vocal) are recorded in the meeting minutes. The Chair has a positive obligation to surface concerns even if quietly raised, not merely to record those forcefully argued.

(c) Test for consensus. The Chair tests for consensus by posing the question explicitly to the TSC: 'Are there remaining substantive objections to this proposal that we have not addressed?' Silence in response to a clearly posed question constitutes assent only after a deliberate pause of no less than thirty (30) seconds in a live session, or no less than seven (7) calendar days in an asynchronous session. The Chair documents the question posed and the form of the silence or response.

(d) Acknowledgment of unresolved concerns. If substantive concerns remain unresolved but no objector seeks to block the consensus call, the Chair declares 'consensus reached over remaining concerns' and documents both the consensus and the specific concerns that were not fully resolved. This distinguishes 'rough consensus' from 'unanimous agreement' and makes the rough nature of the consensus visible in the record.

(e) Vice-Chair check. Per §4.4(f)(ii), the Vice-Chair may at any point call for a formal vote if they believe the Chair has incorrectly applied this protocol. The call must be honored.

(f) Right of dissent. Any TSC member who is overruled by consensus may file a written dissent within seven (7) days, published in the public record per §13 alongside the decision. Dissents do not block the decision but ensure that minority views are preserved.

4.6 Meetings

The TSC meets at least once per calendar quarter, and may convene additional sessions at any time when called by the Chair, by any two (2) TSC members acting jointly, by the Vice-Chair under §4.4(f)(ii), or under the emergency procedures of §9.3. In practice, during the Founding Stage and during periods of active specification development, meetings are expected to occur more frequently than the quarterly minimum. Meetings may be conducted in person, by video conference, or by any electronic means. Minutes are published publicly within fourteen (14) calendar days. A quorum of the TSC consists of four (4) of seven (7) members.

4.7 Removal of TSC Members

A TSC member may be removed by Supermajority vote of the Consejo Directivo with cause documented in the public record, on any of the following grounds:

- (a)** Failure to attend three (3) consecutive scheduled meetings without prior notice and without subsequent justification;
- (b)** Violation of the Code of Conduct as determined by the Code of Conduct review process under §4.8;
- (c)** Material, unresolved conflict of interest as determined under §6;
- (d)** Conduct materially detrimental to the integrity of the TSC or TLF.

4.8 Code of Conduct

TLF adopts the Contributor Covenant v2.1 as its Code of Conduct, applicable to TSC members, Working Group participants, Community Group participants, Officers, contributors, and any individual participating in TLF spaces.

Review Panel. Reports of violations are directed to conduct@trustlayer.foundation and reviewed by a Code of Conduct Review Panel. Panel composition depends on the subject of the report:

(a) For reports involving a Consejo member, the Secretario, or a member of the founding family — the Panel is drawn from a standing pool of at least three (3) external reviewers from adjacent standards bodies (e.g., DIF, OpenID Foundation, W3C), agreed in advance by the Consejo. Identification of this external pool is a precondition for circulation of this Framework to external stakeholders and is tracked as a critical-priority item in the Open Decisions sidepage.

(b) For all other reports — the Panel consists of the Secretario plus two (2) TSC members not involved in the report, with the requirement that at least one (1) Panel member be from outside the founding family and outside any Affiliated Entity.

Appeal. Decisions of the Review Panel may be appealed within fifteen (15) calendar days to the Consejo Directivo. If either party is dissatisfied with the Consejo's decision, a final appeal may be made to a panel of three (3) reviewers from the external standing pool.

5. Anti-Capture Provisions

These provisions are the legal foundation of TLF's credibility as a neutral standards body. Modification requires Supermajority of the Consejo and 90-day public notice.

5.1 No Single-Entity Control

No single entity — including any of the Foundation's founders, any Affiliated Entity (including but not limited to TUNO Labs and Punto 2012), any acquirer, successor, or assignee — shall obtain control of: (a) any TLF-stewarded specification; (b) the operational infrastructure of any TLF-stewarded standard; (c) a majority of seats on the TSC; (d) the licensing terms under which specifications are published; (e) the trademarks of TLF or its stewarded standards (see §8.6).

5.2 IP Lock Clause

All specifications published by TLF are licensed under Apache 2.0 (code) and CC-BY-4.0 (documentation), or equally permissive open licenses approved by the Consejo. Once published, a specification's license shall not be changed to a more restrictive license. This clause survives dissolution of the Foundation.

5.3 Fork Protection

If the Foundation is dissolved, ceases to operate, is acquired by a commercial entity, or fails to maintain its nonprofit character for any continuous twelve-month period, all published specifications shall automatically become available under the most permissive license under which they were ever published. The copyright shall transfer to a successor nonprofit identified by the Consejo prior to dissolution, or if no successor is identified, to the public domain.

Definition of 'ceases to operate'. The Foundation is deemed to have ceased to operate when any of the following occurs: (i) no Consejo Directivo meeting has been held for twelve (12) consecutive months; (ii) no public communication, release, or specification update has occurred for twelve (12) consecutive months; or (iii) the Consejo Directivo formally resolves to suspend operations.

An additional 'constructive abandonment' trigger — covering scenarios where the Foundation is formally active but produces no substantive output — is identified as a v1.5.1 or v1.6 improvement item in the Open Decisions sidepage. The drafting of this provision benefits from W3C CG and TSC input before adoption.

5.4 Operational Independence

Where a TLF-stewarded standard involves operational infrastructure, that infrastructure is designed to be operable by any competent entity. The published specification includes sufficient detail for any implementer to build a conformant implementation. TLF maintains the right to license multiple operators (see §11.4).

5.5 Affiliated Entity Limitations

No Affiliated Entity shall: (a) have permanent exclusive rights to implement any TLF specification; (b) hold more than two (2) seats on the TSC simultaneously; (c) veto any TSC decision; (d) prevent publication of a specification approved by the TSC; (e) restrict third parties from implementing published specifications; (f) hold any trademark, domain name, or trade dress that would impede a competing implementation from using the standard.

5.6 Federation Mandate

TLF pursues the establishment of a federation of independent operators implementing TLF-stewarded standards:

- (a)** TLF publishes operator licensing terms (ROLA template) within a reasonable period after the relevant standard reaches operational maturity, targeted at month 18 per §1.6.3 and §11.2.B.
- (b)** TLF accepts operator applications from any qualified entity on substantially equivalent terms.
- (c)** TLF pursues the onboarding of additional independent operators as the ecosystem matures.
- (d)** TLF does not enter into any agreement that grants any single operator exclusivity, preferential rates, or veto rights over the entry of additional operators.

5.7 Cross-Network Interoperability

TLF acknowledges that digital trust infrastructure exists within a broader ecosystem of standards bodies. TLF may engage with adjacent open trust infrastructures and standards bodies where engagement serves TLF's mission.

6. Conflict of Interest Policy

6.1 Disclosure Obligation

Each Consejo member, TSC member, and Officer discloses in writing any material interest in an Affiliated Entity at the time of appointment and within thirty (30) days of any change. A 'material interest' includes ownership, employment, consulting relationships, board membership, or any financial arrangement exceeding USD \$10,000 annually.

6.2 Known Conflicts at Constitution

The following conflicts and family relationships are acknowledged at the time of TLF's constitution:

Person	Role in TLF	Affiliated Interest / Family	Mitigation Measures
Aaron A. Grego Rell	Presidente; TSC Chair (Founding Stage)	Co-founder of TUNO Labs; Director General of Punto 2012; son of Carlos Grego Samra; cousin of Adolfo Grego Micha	• Recusal on all TUNO Labs commercial terms • Recusal on all Punto 2012 commercial terms • No vote on Affiliated Entity agreements involving these entities • DNS sector recusal per §6.5
Iván Moreno Mendoza	Vocal; ARIA WG Chair; UCDM WG Chair (interim)	Co-founder of TUNO Labs	• Recusal on all TUNO Labs commercial terms • Per §4.2.1(b), Iván does not hold a TSC seat during Aaron's tenure as Chair • Per §4.5, participates in TSC sessions with voice and consultative vote on implementation-impact matters
Adolfo Grego Micha	Secretario; W3C Agent Identity CG Chair	Partner in Punto 2012; cousin of Aaron Grego Rell	• Recusal on Punto 2012-related decisions • CG Chair role disclosed per §7.8 — TSC liaison authority resides in the Liaison Co-Chair (elected per §7.8.4 with structural independence requirements), not in the CG Chair when CG Chair is founder-affiliated
Carlos Grego Samra	Tesorero	Partner in TUNO Labs; partner in Punto 2012; father of Aaron Grego Rell	• Recusal on all TUNO Labs commercial terms • Recusal on all Punto 2012 commercial terms

Person	Role in TLF	Affiliated Interest / Family	Mitigation Measures
			• Recusal on compensation matters involving Aaron

6.3 Recusal Procedure

When a conflict exists, the conflicted member: (a) declares the conflict before discussion begins; (b) recuses themselves from discussion and voting on the matter; (c) leaves the room (physical or virtual) during deliberation. Recusals are recorded in the meeting minutes.

6.4 Annual Disclosure

All Consejo members, TSC members, and Officers submit an updated conflict of interest disclosure annually. The Secretario maintains the registry of disclosures.

6.5 DNS Sector Recusal

Because the Founder serves as Director General of Punto 2012 (an ICANN-contracted gTLD registry operating .bar and .rest) and the ARIA Protocol uses DNS anchoring, the Founder commits to the following bounded recusal scope:

- (a)** No advocacy at ICANN, registry/registrar forums, or related DNS-policy bodies for changes that would create preferential rights for Punto 2012-operated gTLDs over other gTLDs or ccTLDs;
- (b)** Recusal from any ICANN community vote where the matter would create competitive or commercial advantage specifically for Punto 2012;
- (c)** Public acknowledgment that ARIA's DNS-anchoring uses public DNS infrastructure available to all gTLDs and ccTLDs equally.

Scope clarification. Advocacy for DNS-related best practices that benefit ARIA, agent-identity infrastructure, or open standards generally — without preferential treatment of Punto 2012 — is permitted and is in the public interest.

7. Working Groups and Community Groups

7.1 Formation

A Working Group (WG) is formed by TSC resolution upon receipt of a proposal containing: (a) the proposed name and scope; (b) the initial Chair(s) and Editor(s); (c) the specific deliverables and timeline; (d) alignment with TLF's mission. The TSC approves WG formation by Rough Consensus. Community Groups (CGs) chartered in relation to TLF-stewarded specifications are governed by §7.8.

7.2 Participation

Participation in Working Groups is open to all. Membership in TLF is not required to contribute. All Contributors must agree to the IPR Policy (Section 8). Active Working Group Participants (as defined in §2) are subject to the patent provisions of §8.4 and §8.7.

7.3 Decision-Making

Working Groups operate by Rough Consensus following the principles of §4.5.1 as applicable. The WG Chair determines consensus. Unresolved disputes are escalated to the TSC.

7.4 Deliverable Lifecycle

Specifications progress through four stages: (1) Proposal; (2) Working Draft; (3) Implementer's Draft; (4) Final Specification.

Transition criteria:

- **Proposal → Working Draft (1 → 2).** Approved by TSC lazy consensus on the WG charter and initial scope.
- **Working Draft → Implementer's Draft (2 → 3).** Approved by the relevant Working Group via Rough Consensus, then ratified by TSC lazy consensus. Public comment period of ninety (90) calendar days begins upon entry into Implementer's Draft status.
- **Implementer's Draft → Final Specification (3 → 4).** Requires: (i) completion of the 90-day public comment period with substantive comments resolved; (ii) at least two (2) independent implementations demonstrating interoperability; (iii) formal TSC approval by Rough Consensus or simple majority vote.

Post-Final implementation grace period. Following publication of a Final Specification, operators have a minimum of ninety (90) calendar days to achieve conformance, extensible to one hundred eighty (180) days when third parties are materially affected. Credentials issued under the prior specification version are grandfathered through their natural expiration period.

7.5 Initial Working Groups

Working Group	Scope	Initial Chair
ARIA Protocol WG	Core ARIA specification, DID method, credential format, trust levels, revocation. Security review and threat modeling for ARIA are conducted within this Working Group.	Iván Moreno Mendoza (Vocal; CTO)
UCDM Protocol WG (chartered in pre-activation)	Universal Commerce Data Model — verifiable commercial data, product identifiers, transactional records. The Working Group is chartered in pre-activation status; activation occurs upon publication of the initial Implementer's Draft of the UCDM specification.	Iván Moreno Mendoza (Vocal; CTO, interim)

7.6 Relationships with External Standards Bodies

TLF Working Groups operate in coordination with related standards work in external bodies. TLF distinguishes two modes of relationship:

(a) Formal Community Group presence. Where TLF establishes or co-chairs a Community Group within an external standards body to incubate community input on a TLF-stewarded specification, the relationship between that CG and the TSC is governed by §7.8. The TSC documents the nature of each formal CG relationship in the relevant WG charter or in a liaison record maintained in the public repository per §13.2(b).

(b) Informal participation as contributor. Where TLF participates in an external standards body as a contributor (submitting drafts, comments, or proposals) rather than as a CG steward, the engagement is governed by §11.5 (Cross-Network Engagement) and the Consejo's institutional-relationships authority under §3.1.1(f). Examples include IETF Internet-Draft submissions, UNTP extension proposals, ITU-T SG17 comment submissions, and ISO/IEC JTC 1 contributions.

External bodies of current or anticipated relevance:

- **W3C** — including the W3C Agent Identity Community Group (chartered May 2026, Chair: Adolfo Grego Micha) currently being coordinated with the TLF ARIA Protocol WG; and future W3C CGs that may be established for UCDM and additional TLF-stewarded standards.
- **IETF** — Working Groups on credentials, identity, and authorization protocols. Mode (b) — informal participation.
- **DIF (Decentralized Identity Foundation)** — DID methods, verifiable credentials, trust frameworks.
- **OpenID Foundation** — AIIM, FAPI, and related working groups.
- **UN/CEFACT** — relevant to UCDM scope; primary venue for UNTP coordination. Mode (b).
- **UNTP / Community Activation Program** — sector-specific verifiable-credentials extensions for commerce and supply chain.

- **GS1** — global product identification standards; relevant to UCDM.
- **ISO/IEC JTC 1 / SC 32** — data management and interchange standards.
- **ToIP (Trust over IP Foundation)** — governance metamodel and trust framework alignment.
- **NIST** — particularly the National Cybersecurity Center of Excellence (NCCoE) work on AI agent identity. Mode (b).
- **ETSI, CEN, CENELEC** — European harmonized standards bodies relevant to EU AI Act compliance. Mode (b).
- **ITU-T** — including SG17 on security, where Mexico has direct representation. Mode (b).

7.7 Editor Role

Each Working Group designates one or more Editors by WG resolution. The Editor role is operational, not normative:

(a) Editorial responsibilities. Maintains the canonical specification text; integrates accepted Contributions; resolves editorial ambiguities pending formal WG disposition; prepares release candidates for TSC approval.

(b) Operator coordination. Coordinates with each operator's CTO on implementation grace periods (§7.4), version migration planning, and hotfix releases (§9.4).

(c) No normative authority. The Editor does not make substantive decisions on specification content.

(d) Removal and succession. Editors may be replaced by WG resolution at any time.

7.8 Community Groups

This section establishes the general framework for Community Groups across all TLF-stewarded specifications. It applies to the current W3C Agent Identity CG and to any future Community Groups TLF establishes or co-chairs — including future CGs that may be established for UCDM or other standards. The framework is intentionally written to be plural-aware: no §7.8 amendment is required when additional CGs are formed; each new CG is documented in the liaison record per §13.2(b).

7.8.1 Definition and Role

A Community Group (CG) chartered in relation to a TLF-stewarded specification is an advisory body. It produces recommendations, use cases, reports, and community input. It does not have normative authority over any TLF specification. Normative authority remains with the TSC per §4. The Foundation establishes and supports Community Groups as a deliberate mechanism for public-interest input, and treats CG participation as a valued contribution to the specification process — not merely a formality.

Scope clarification. This Section governs TLF's relationships with formal Community Groups. TLF's engagement with external standards bodies where TLF participates as a contributor rather than as a CG steward (per §7.6(b)) is governed by §11.5 (Cross-Network Engagement). TLF's coordination with regulators (e.g., NIST, Mexican regulatory authorities, EU AI Office) is conducted under the Consejo

Directivo's authority per §3.1.1(f); such regulatory engagement does not, in itself, constitute a Community Group relationship under this Section.

7.8.2 TSC Obligations Toward Community Groups

When a Community Group formally adopts a Recommendation — a documented position supported by rough consensus of the CG — the TSC has the following obligations:

(a) Formal response. The TSC must publish a written response within thirty (30) calendar days of receiving a CG Recommendation, stating whether the Recommendation is: (i) adopted into the specification process; (ii) deferred with a documented timeline; or (iii) declined, with specific technical reasoning. Silence does not constitute a response.

(b) CG Liaison presence. When a CG Recommendation is on the agenda of a TSC session, the TSC Chair must invite the designated CG Liaison Co-Chair (see §7.8.4) to attend that session as an observer with speaking rights. The Liaison Co-Chair does not vote. The Liaison's presence and any substantive statements are recorded in the TSC minutes.

7.8.3 TSC-to-CG Specification Change Communications

The TSC keeps active Community Groups informed of specification changes across four tiers:

(a) Non-breaking changes (§9.1). The TSC notifies the CG mailing list within seven (7) calendar days of approval. No CG comment period is required. The CG may raise concerns through its normal recommendation process at any time.

(b) Breaking changes (§9.2). Before a breaking change is finalized, the TSC opens a fourteen (14) calendar day comment window to the CG mailing list. Comments received are considered in TSC deliberations. The TSC is not bound by CG comments but must acknowledge them in its decision record.

(c) Hotfixes / Emergency security amendments (§9.3–9.4). Because hotfixes carry immediate normative weight and bypass the standard comment period by design, no CG comment window applies. The TSC notifies the CG mailing list immediately upon hotfix publication, including the technical assessment and the nature of the remediation. During the mandatory thirty (30) day retroactive review under §9.3(d), the CG mailing list is explicitly included in the review audience.

(d) Deprecation notices. When the TSC identifies a feature or behavior for deprecation in advance of a future breaking change, the TSC notifies the CG mailing list as early as practicable — and in any case no later than the opening of the breaking change comment window.

(e) Standing briefing. At each regularly scheduled CG meeting, a standing agenda item covers recent and upcoming TSC activity, even when no formal change is under review. This may be delivered by the CG Chair, the Liaison Co-Chair, or a designated TSC representative.

7.8.4 CG Liaison Co-Chair

Each Community Group may designate a Liaison Co-Chair. The Liaison Co-Chair is a standing officer of the CG whose responsibilities are:

- (a) To attend TSC sessions when CG Recommendations are on the agenda, per §7.8.2(b);
- (b) To report back to the CG on the outcome of those TSC sessions;
- (c) To serve as the primary point of contact between the CG and the TSC for coordination purposes.

Eligibility. To be eligible for the Liaison Co-Chair role, an individual must:

- (i) Qualify as an Active Working Group Participant of the CG — having attended three (3) or more CG meetings within a rolling twelve-month period and having made substantive contributions to CG discussions or deliverables; and
- (ii) Have no employment, board membership, or commercial compensation relationship with TLF, TUNO Labs, Punto 2012, or any other Affiliated Entity as defined in §2. The independence requirement ensures the Liaison Co-Chair genuinely represents the CG community's perspective in TSC deliberations.

Formation period. During the first sixty (60) days of a CG's operation, no participant will yet have met the participation threshold. During this formation period, the CG Chair temporarily fulfills the Liaison Co-Chair's TSC attendance and reporting responsibilities until a qualified candidate is elected. Where the CG Chair is structurally affiliated with TLF (e.g., a founding-family member), the Chair MAY recuse from the temporary Liaison role and request that the TSC accept a different non-affiliated CG participant in an interim observer capacity until a qualified Liaison Co-Chair is elected.

The Liaison Co-Chair holds no voting authority in TSC sessions. The role is filled by CG election. The Liaison Co-Chair role is distinct from the CG Chair role and must be held by a different person once the CG has a participant base sufficient to separate them.

7.8.5 Meeting Cadence and Public Record

Community Groups operating under TLF's coordination meet at a regular cadence defined in their charter. Meeting minutes are published publicly within ten (10) calendar days of each meeting, consistent with §13 (Transparency & Public Record). All technical work occurs in the CG's public GitHub repository. The CG Chair is responsible for ensuring continuity of the public record.

8. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) Policy

This Section is modeled on the OpenID Foundation IPR Policy and adapted for TLF's structure as a Mexican A.C.

8.1 Outbound Licensing

All specifications published by TLF are available under: (a) Apache License 2.0 for code, reference implementations, SDKs, and test suites; (b) Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC-BY-4.0) for specification text, documentation, and non-code deliverables. No specification is published under a more restrictive license without Supermajority approval of both the Consejo and the TSC.

8.2 Inbound Contributions — Developer Certificate of Origin

TLF's default contribution mechanism is the Developer Certificate of Origin (DCO) v1.1. Contributors attest to the DCO by adding a 'Signed-off-by' line to each commit.

8.3 Contributor License Agreement

The TSC may require a formal CLA for specific Working Groups where patent exposure or institutional contributor risk is significant.

8.4 Patent Non-Assertion Covenant

Each Contributor, by making a Contribution to a TLF specification, grants to TLF and to all recipients of the specification a perpetual, worldwide, non-exclusive, royalty-free, irrevocable license under any patent claims licensable by the Contributor that are necessarily infringed by the Contribution.

Extension to Active Working Group Participants. This non-assertion covenant extends to Active Working Group Participants (as defined in §2 and including active Community Group participants per §7.8): any individual or entity that has attended three (3) or more WG or CG meetings within a rolling twelve-month period, or has submitted substantive technical input to the WG or CG record, is subject to the same Patent Non-Assertion Covenant as a Contributor.

Termination for litigation. If any entity institutes patent litigation alleging that a Contribution or the specification constitutes patent infringement, the patent license granted by that entity under this Section terminates.

8.5 Copyright Ownership

Copyright in TLF specifications is held by TrustLayer Foundation, A.C. The IP Assignment Agreements between the founders (Aaron A. Grego Rell and Iván Moreno Mendoza) and TLF are to be executed prior to the first public commercial release of any TLF-stewarded specification and are an operational priority

deliverable per Open Decisions sidepage B.5. Execution is currently pending resolution of TLF's entity RFC registration at SAT. INDAUTOR (Mexican copyright registry) copyright registration follows execution.

8.6 Trademark Policy

The names 'ARIA', 'TrustLayer Foundation', 'TLF', the Alberti cipher disk logo, and associated marks are pursued as trademarks of TrustLayer Foundation, A.C. Trademark registration with IMPI (Mexico) is in progress; international registrations may follow as adoption requires.

8.7 Patent Disclosure Obligations

Contributors and Active Working Group Participants (including Community Group participants per §7.8) disclose, to the best of their knowledge and on a reasonable-inquiry basis, any patents owned by them or by their employer that would be necessarily infringed by implementation of the specification being developed by that Working Group or Community Group.

8.8 No Patent Indemnification by TLF

TLF does not provide patent indemnification to adopters of TLF-stewarded specifications. Adopters are responsible for conducting their own patent clearance.

9. Specification Amendment Procedure

9.1 Non-Breaking Changes

Non-breaking changes may be approved by Lazy Consensus of the TSC with a seven (7) day objection period. CG notification per §7.8.3(a) applies.

9.2 Breaking Changes

Breaking changes require:

- (a)** A ninety (90) calendar day public comment period;
- (b)** Resolution of all substantive comments raised during the comment period;
- (c)** A formal vote of the TSC with Supermajority approval (five of seven members);
- (d) Implementation grace period.** A minimum of ninety (90) calendar days after publication before the change becomes normative, extensible to one hundred eighty (180) days when third parties are materially affected;
- (e) Grandfathering of existing credentials.** Credentials issued under the prior specification version remain valid through their natural expiration period unless the amendment specifically addresses a security vulnerability requiring revocation.

CG notification per §7.8.3(b) applies.

9.3 Emergency Security Amendments

If a critical security vulnerability is discovered in a published specification, emergency procedures apply.

- (a) Declaration of emergency.** A security emergency may be declared by: (i) the TSC Chair; (ii) any two (2) TSC members acting jointly; or (iii) the CTO of an operator in interim authority. Declaration requires a written technical assessment.
- (b) Emergency TSC session.** Within forty-eight (48) hours of declaration, the TSC convenes an emergency session. The Vocal (CTO of TLF) participates with voice and consultative vote regardless of TSC membership status, per §4.5.
- (c) Immediate implementation.** Upon TSC approval, operators implement the amendment immediately. The amendment carries normative weight from the moment of TSC approval. The version is published as a hotfix per §9.4.
- (d) Retroactive review.** Within thirty (30) calendar days of TSC approval, a retroactive review is conducted. The TSC publishes the original technical assessment, the implemented remediation, observed impact, and any modifications required. CG notification per §7.8.3(c) applies.

9.4 Versioning and Canonical Source

Specifications follow Semantic Versioning (SemVer 2.0): MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH.

Hotfix designation. Emergency security amendments approved under §9.3 are published with the version format MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH-hotfix.N. Hotfix releases: (a) carry full normative weight immediately upon publication; (b) bypass the standard public comment period; (c) are incorporated into the next scheduled PATCH release; (d) signal to implementers that immediate action is required.

All published versions are permanently available at their canonical URI.

10. Dispute Resolution

10.1 Scope and Categories

This Section establishes dispute resolution mechanisms for three categories of disputes:

- (a) Operational disputes.** Disputes regarding TLF-stewarded standards in operation.
- (b) Governance disputes.** Disputes within the Foundation's organs, including appeals of TSC decisions on specification matters.
- (c) Federation disputes.** Disputes between operators.

10.2 Internal Resolution

Disputes are first addressed through internal resolution by the appropriate body.

- (a) Operational and federation disputes** are initially addressed by the TSC.
- (b) Governance disputes** are initially addressed by the Consejo Directivo.
- (c) Code of Conduct matters** follow the procedures of §4.8.

Mandatory recusal. In any dispute involving an Affiliated Entity, Consejo and TSC members affiliated with that entity recuse themselves per §6.3.

10.3 Filing and Process

- (a) Filing.** The complainant submits a written complaint to disputes@trustlayer.foundation.
- (b) Response.** The respondent has twenty (20) calendar days to respond.
- (c) Internal review.** The appropriate body per §10.2 reviews submissions.
- (d) Decision.** A written decision is issued within thirty (30) calendar days.
- (e) Publication.** All decisions are published, with confidential information redacted.

A lightweight Formal Objection process — distinct from internal resolution and external arbitration, modeled on W3C Formal Objection — is identified as a v1.5.1 or v1.6 improvement item in the Open Decisions sidepage.

10.4 External Arbitration

If either party is dissatisfied with the internal resolution, or if the dispute involves structural conflicts that make internal resolution inappropriate, the matter is referred to external arbitration.

- (a) For disputes with a Mexican jurisdictional center of gravity** — arbitration is conducted under the rules of the Centro de Arbitraje de México (CAM), seated in Ciudad de México.

(b) For disputes with an international jurisdictional center of gravity — arbitration is conducted under the rules of the International Chamber of Commerce (ICC) International Court of Arbitration, with seat agreed by the parties or, failing agreement, in Ciudad de México.

(c) Number of arbitrators. One (1) arbitrator for limited matters; three (3) for substantial disputes.

(d) Cost allocation. Each party bears its own costs unless the arbitrator orders otherwise.

(e) Binding effect. Arbitration decisions are binding on the parties.

10.5 Remedies by Category

Operational remedies: reinstatement of a revoked credential; correction of operational records; revocation of a credential found to be fraudulent; technical remediation orders.

Governance remedies: suspension or removal of a Working Group participant; remand of a TSC decision for reconsideration.

Federation remedies: suspension or termination of an operator's license; remediation orders for cross-operator coordination failures.

Monetary remedies. Internal resolution does not award monetary damages. External arbitration may award monetary remedies in accordance with the applicable arbitration rules and applicable law.

11. Affiliated Entity Relationships

11.1 Structural Principle

TLF, as the nonprofit standards steward, exists structurally distinct from any commercial entity. The Foundation's founders also hold interests in commercial entities — notably TUNO Labs, S.A.P.I. de C.V., and Punto 2012 — which interact with TLF in defined ways. This Section establishes the framework that governs those relationships.

Two-entity model. TLF (nonprofit, owner of standards, trademarks, IP, and the Trust Ledger of TLF-stewarded specifications) and TUNO Labs (commercial entity, registry operator) are *siblings*, not parent-subsidiary. The relationship is modeled on the Apache Software Foundation and Linux Foundation pattern with adaptations for Mexican legal form.

Two contracts, not phases. The TLF–TUNO Labs relationship is governed by two distinct contracts that exist in parallel, not consecutively:

- **§11.2.A — Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo** (technology development and operational services). Governs TUNO's construction of registry infrastructure, SDKs, resolver, and related technology, with IP retention by TUNO subject to open-access guarantees to TLF.
- **§11.2.B — Registry Operator License Agreement (ROLA)** (operator license). Governs TUNO's operation of ARIA registry services to commercial subscribers, on terms substantially identical to those offered to any other qualified operator.

Earlier drafts of this Framework treated these as consecutive phases. v1.5 corrects this: they are parallel contracts with distinct purposes, signed independently, surviving independently.

11.2 TUNO Labs Relationship

11.2.A Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo (Services and Development Agreement)

The Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo governs TUNO Labs's development and operation of the technology infrastructure supporting the ARIA Protocol — including the registry system, the resolver at `api.aria.bar`, the registry portal at `registry.aria.bar`, the `@aria-registry/verify` SDK, and related software.

(a) Subject matter. Software development, infrastructure operation, and technology services provided by TUNO Labs in connection with TLF-stewarded specifications.

(b) Intellectual property model. TUNO Labs retains commercial ownership of software it develops, subject to the following non-negotiable conditions that protect TLF's open-standards mandate:

(i) Reference implementation open source. TUNO Labs contributes to TLF, under Apache License 2.0 with copyright held by TrustLayer Foundation, A.C. per §8.5, a working reference implementation of each major component (resolver, SDK, registry protocol logic) sufficient for any competent third party to build an interoperable implementation of the relevant TLF-stewarded specification. The reference

implementation is published at the canonical TLF GitHub organization and is updated in pace with the specification.

(ii) TUNO commercial IP retention. TUNO Labs retains exclusive commercial IP in: orchestration tooling, commercial dashboards, billing and account-management systems, customer-support tooling, internal observability infrastructure, and any other software not necessary for third-party interoperability.

(iii) Open-access guarantee. Notwithstanding TUNO's commercial IP retention, no implementation choice, API design, data structure, or operational practice by TUNO Labs may impede a competing registry operator from building or operating an interoperable implementation of any TLF-stewarded specification. This is a binding constraint on TUNO's IP retention rights and is enforceable under the Federation Mandate of §5.6.

(iv) Successor protection. If TUNO Labs is acquired, dissolves, or ceases to operate, the reference implementations published per (i) remain available under Apache 2.0 with copyright held by TLF. TLF or any successor operator may continue operation of the technology without dependence on TUNO Labs corporate continuity.

(c) Economic terms. During the Founding Stage, TUNO Labs provides its technology development to TLF as a contribution in kind, not as a fee-for-service. Specifically:

(i) No service fees flow from TLF to TUNO Labs for the development and operation of the reference implementation. TUNO Labs recovers its development investment through commercial operation under the ROLA (§11.2.B) and through retained commercial IP per (b)(ii).

(ii) No revenue share applies to the Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo. Revenue share between TUNO Labs and TLF arises exclusively from the ROLA (§11.2.B), not from this Agreement.

(iii) Out-of-pocket costs. Direct out-of-pocket infrastructure costs incurred by TUNO Labs specifically for TLF benefit (e.g., domain registration, certificate issuance) may be reimbursed by TLF subject to Consejo approval, documented in the annual financial summary per §13.4.

(d) Term. The Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo is open-ended, terminable by either party on twelve (12) months' written notice. Termination does not affect rights and obligations under reference implementations already contributed per (b)(i).

(e) Provisional language pending execution. Until the Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo is formally executed, TUNO Labs's development and operational activities in support of TLF-stewarded specifications are governed by this Section §11.2.A as institutional commitment. TUNO Labs's operational authority during this interim period is provisional and conditional on subsequent execution of the formal Agreement. Any implementation choices made during this interim period that would impede competing registries are contrary to the Federation Mandate of §5.6 regardless of the formal status of the Agreement.

(f) Execution timeline. Formalization of the Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo is a priority operational deliverable for Q2-Q3 2026, per §1.6.3.

11.2.B Registry Operator License Agreement (ROLA)

The Registry Operator License Agreement (ROLA) is the standard license under which any qualified registry operator — including TUNO Labs — implements and operates a TLF-stewarded standard for commercial subscribers.

(a) Non-exclusivity (foundational principle). Non-exclusivity is a foundational principle of TLF's relationship with all registry operators. No operator, including TUNO Labs, holds exclusive rights to operate any TLF-stewarded standard. This principle survives any change of control of TUNO Labs or any other operator and is structurally protected by §5 Anti-Capture Provisions.

(b) Substantially identical terms. The ROLA executed with TUNO Labs is substantially identical to the ROLA executed with any other qualified registry operator. Variations are limited to commercially neutral operational matters (e.g., contact details, technical-integration parameters); no variation creates differential rights, preferential rates, or competitive advantage for any operator. This identity-of-terms is the structural proof of the non-exclusivity principle of (a).

(c) Revenue share. The ROLA provides for a revenue share of operator net ARIA-related revenue payable from the operator to TLF, applied identically to all operators. The specific rate is established in the ROLA template (per §11.2.B(e) and §1.6.3, the template is drafted by month 18) and may be modified only by Consejo Supermajority with documented rationale published in the public record per §13. Any rate modification applies prospectively to all operators on identical terms. The structural commitment is that the rate is the same for TUNO Labs as for any other qualified operator; this identity of terms is the structural proof of the non-exclusivity principle of (a) and (b).

(d) Qualification criteria. To qualify as a registry operator and execute the ROLA, an applicant must meet criteria established by the TSC in the ROLA template. Criteria include: technical capability, financial soundness, insurance coverage (Errors & Omissions and Cyber Liability at minimums to be specified), agreement to the TLF Code of Conduct, agreement to specification conformance obligations, and acceptance of TLF audit rights.

(e) ROLA template publication. The ROLA template is drafted by month 18 per §1.6.3 and published at trustlayer.foundation/rola. The template is reviewed by external counsel (Mike Rodenbaugh) and approved by Consejo Supermajority before publication. Once published, the template is the basis for all operator applications.

(f) TUNO Labs ROLA execution. TUNO Labs is expected to execute the ROLA upon its publication, on terms identical to those offered to any other qualified operator. TUNO Labs's interim operational activities under the Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo (§11.2.A) transition to ROLA-governed commercial operation upon execution.

(g) Mandatory recusal on TUNO ROLA matters. All Consejo members affiliated with TUNO Labs (Aaron, Iván, Carlos per §6.2) recuse from any decision concerning the terms, execution, or modification of TUNO Labs's ROLA. The unaffiliated Consejo member (Adolfo, as Secretario) approves TUNO's ROLA

execution; if the Consejo has expanded by then, the approval requires Supermajority of unaffiliated members.

11.3 Punto 2012 Relationship

Punto 2012 operates the .bar and .rest gTLDs under ICANN contract. ARIA uses DNS anchoring as part of its trust architecture, with the canonical Foundation domain at trustlayer.foundation and the canonical specification domain at aria.bar.

(a) Equal treatment. Punto 2012 receives no preferential rights in any TLF-stewarded standard. Any commercial relationship between TLF and Punto 2012 (e.g., domain hosting, registry services) operates at arm's length and on commercially reasonable terms documented and approved by Consejo Supermajority per §3.1.3.

(b) DNS architecture neutrality. ARIA's DNS anchoring uses public DNS infrastructure available to all gTLDs and ccTLDs equally. No ARIA specification provision creates a structural preference for Punto 2012-operated gTLDs.

(c) Founder recusal. Per §6.5, the Founder recuses from ICANN advocacy that would create preferential rights for Punto 2012-operated gTLDs.

11.4 Future Operators and the Federation

TLF actively pursues the onboarding of additional independent operators under the ROLA per §5.6 and §11.2.B. The Federation is the operationalization of the non-exclusivity principle: as the Federation grows from a single operator to multiple, the structural protection of non-exclusivity becomes demonstrated in practice.

TLF maintains ongoing outreach to qualified candidate operators (e.g., Tucows/MarkMonitor, other gTLD registries with relevant capability) and reports federation expansion status in the annual Maturity Report per §13.9.

11.5 Cross-Network Engagement

TLF acknowledges that digital trust infrastructure exists within a broader ecosystem of open standards bodies. TLF may engage with adjacent open trust infrastructures and standards bodies — including but not limited to W3C, IETF, DIF, OpenID Foundation, ToIP, NIST, UN/CEFACT, GS1, ISO/IEC, ITU-T, and ETSI — where such engagement serves TLF's mission. The framework for engagement is established in §7.6, distinguishing formal Community Group presence (governed by §7.8) from informal contributor participation.

Engagement that constitutes formal institutional partnership with another standards body requires Consejo approval and is documented in the public record per §13.

11.6 Future Affiliated Entities

Should new Affiliated Entities arise — through founder activities outside TLF/TUNO/Punto, through Consejo expansion bringing additional affiliations, or through other circumstances — each is documented in §6.2 by amendment of this Framework, subject to disclosure obligations of §6.1, and governed by the same recusal and Supermajority requirements applicable to existing Affiliated Entities.

12. Membership Model

This Section establishes the Foundation's membership framework. Membership is distinct from Asociado status (see §3.4): Members participate in Working Groups and Community Groups and contribute to the Foundation's mission, while Asociados hold voting rights in the Asamblea General per the Acta.

Admission of Members to Asociado status follows §3.4.1.

12.1 Founding-Stage Posture

During the Founding Stage, Membership tier activation is a Consejo decision. The Open Decisions sidepage tracks Membership-model decisions pending Consejo resolution. The default posture is that participation in Working Groups and Community Groups is open to all without formal Membership, subject to IPR Policy agreement per §8.

12.2 Tier Framework (forward-looking)

When Membership tiers are activated, the following framework applies:

- **Contributor tier** — individuals or entities who have made at least one accepted Contribution to a TLF specification. Open enrollment. No dues during Founding Stage.
- **Individual tier** — individuals supporting the Foundation's mission. Annual dues to be established by Consejo. May be waived for hardship or for early-stage supporters.
- **Corporate tier** — legal entities supporting the Foundation's mission. Annual dues established by Consejo. Different rates by organization size.

12.3 Member Rights and Obligations

All Members agree to the Code of Conduct (§4.8) and the IPR Policy (§8). Members in good standing have the right to participate in Working Groups and Community Groups, propose initiatives, nominate Asociado candidates after two years per §3.4.1(b)(iii), and access Member-exclusive resources where applicable.

12.4 No Commercial Gating

Specifications published by TLF are not gated by Membership. Any individual or entity may implement a TLF-stewarded specification under its published license terms without becoming a Member.

13. Transparency & Public Record

13.1 General Principle

TLF operates as a public-interest steward. All substantive decisions, documents, and records are presumed public unless a specific provision of this Framework or applicable law requires confidentiality. The Foundation's bias is toward publication.

13.2 Public Repositories

(a) Foundation website. trustlayer.foundation publishes the canonical version of this Framework, the Acta Constitutiva (in appropriate redacted form), the Maturity Reports, the annual financial summaries, the Open Decisions sidepage, the privacy notice (forthcoming per §15), and other institutional documents.

(b) Public repository. A public GitHub organization maintains specifications, working group documents, meeting minutes, Community Group liaison records, and the canonical text of each TLF-stewarded standard. The liaison record per §7.8 documents each formal CG relationship.

(c) Canonical specification URIs. Each TLF-stewarded specification is published at a canonical URI. ARIA at aria.bar/spec. UCDM at its forthcoming canonical URI.

13.3 Meeting Records

Minutes of Consejo, TSC, Working Group, and Community Group meetings are published per the cadence specified in the relevant Section (§3.1.2, §4.6, §7, §7.8.5).

13.4 Financial Summary

The Foundation publishes an annual financial summary including: total revenue, total expenses by category, asset holdings, and any compensation to Consejo members or Officers. Detailed financial statements are reviewed by the Comisario per §3.2.

13.5 Decision Records

Substantive decisions of the Consejo, TSC, and Asamblea are documented in writing with rationale. Decision records are published per the cadence of the relevant body's minutes obligation.

13.6 Public Comment Records

Public comments received during specification comment periods (§7.4, §9), during Asociado admission comment periods (§3.4.1(c)), and during TSC appointment community preview periods (§4.3.1(b)) are published in the relevant decision record with comment authors' permission or in appropriately anonymized form.

13.7 Conflict Disclosure Registry

Per §6.4, the Secretario maintains the registry of conflict of interest disclosures, published in summary form annually.

13.8 Open Decisions Sidepage

The Foundation maintains a public Open Decisions sidepage documenting institutional decisions pending resolution, with target dates and current status. This sidepage is updated by the Secretario in coordination with the Consejo.

13.9 Annual Maturity Report

The Foundation publishes an annual Maturity Report assessing progress against §1.6 commitments. The Maturity Report includes, at minimum:

- Status of §1.6.3 commitments against the matrix in §1.6, including any §3.4.1(e) non-compliance disclosures restated and any §4.3.1(e) TSC appointment delays;
- Asociado admission status: number of current Asociados, admissions during the reporting period, and progress toward the three-external-Asociados commitment per §1.6.3;
- TSC composition status: seat-by-seat status, Phase 1 and Phase 2 appointment progress, Vice-Chair election status per §4.4(f);
- Federation status: current operators, applications received, ROLA execution status per §11.2.B;
- Community Group activity: active CGs, Recommendations received, TSC responses issued per §7.8.2(a);
- Specification activity: published versions, breaking changes, hotfixes, security advisories;
- Financial summary per §13.4;
- Open Decisions status: items resolved during the period, items still open.

14. Amendment of These Bylaws

14.1 Authority and Acta Reservation

Modification of the Acta Constitutiva itself is reserved to the Asamblea General per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (VII) and (XVI). Modification of this Framework (Reglamento Interno supplementing the Acta) is governed by this Section and by Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (VIII).

14.2 Amendment Procedure

Amendments to this Framework follow this procedure:

- (a) Proposal.** Any Consejo member, TSC member, or Asociado may propose an amendment in writing.
- (b) Public notice.** The proposed amendment is published with a thirty (30) calendar day public comment period.
- (c) Consejo approval.** After the comment period, the Consejo approves the amendment by simple majority for ordinary amendments, or by Supermajority for amendments to Sections 5 (Anti-Capture), 6 (Conflicts of Interest), 8 (IPR), 10 (Dispute Resolution), 11 (Affiliated Entities), or 14 (this Section).
- (d) Asamblea ratification.** Substantive amendments require ratification by the Asamblea General per Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto (VIII) at its next ordinary session, or by extraordinary session if urgent.
- (e) Publication.** Adopted amendments are published with the next versioned release of this Framework.

14.3 Versioning

This Framework uses semantic versioning. Major versions (1.0, 2.0) reflect substantive structural changes. Minor versions (1.1, 1.2) reflect substantive additions or modifications. Patch versions (1.0.1) reflect editorial corrections without substantive change. Each version is permanently archived at [trustlayer.foundation/governance-framework/\[version\]](https://trustlayer.foundation/governance-framework/[version]).

14.4 Effective Date

Amendments take effect on publication unless the amendment itself specifies a later effective date.

15. Data Protection — Statement of Approach

15.1 Scope and Mexican Jurisdictional Anchor

As a Mexican Asociación Civil, TLF operates under the Ley Federal de Protección de Datos Personales en Posesión de los Particulares (LFPDPPP), enforced by the Instituto Nacional de Transparencia, Acceso a la Información y Protección de Datos Personales (INAI). LFPDPPP governs TLF's processing of personal data, including data of Consejo members, Officers, Members, Contributors, and any other individuals whose data TLF processes.

15.2 Statement of Approach

TLF processes personal data only as necessary for its institutional operation: administration of Asociados, Consejo, TSC, Members, and Contributors; communication with stakeholders; financial and tax compliance; and the operation of Foundation infrastructure. TLF does not process personal data of operator subscribers — that data is processed by operators under their respective ROLA obligations and applicable jurisdictional law.

Privacy notice. A privacy notice compliant with LFPDPPP Article 16 is published at trustlayer.foundation/privacy. Publication of the privacy notice is a high-priority operational deliverable tracked in the Open Decisions sidepage. The privacy notice describes: the personal data processed; the purposes; the legal basis; the data subjects' ARCO rights (Acceso, Rectificación, Cancelación, Oposición); the contact mechanism for data subject requests; and the cookie policy as applicable.

Data subject contact. Data subject requests are directed to privacy@trustlayer.foundation. The Secretario coordinates response per LFPDPPP timelines.

15.3 ARIA Self-Sovereign Data Model

The ARIA Protocol is architected such that personally identifying information is not retained by TLF or by operators beyond what is strictly necessary for credential issuance, presentation, and verification. The ARIA technical specification documents the self-sovereign data model in detail; this Framework references it without restating it.

In the ARIA Protocol, the agent generates its own cryptographic keypair locally. The private key never enters TLF or operator infrastructure. TLF and operators receive only the public key for credential issuance purposes. This architecture means TLF processes no private key material and holds no personally identifying credential content on behalf of any agent or principal. The GDPR right-to-erasure question for credential data is therefore resolved at the architectural level: there is nothing for TLF to erase.

Appendix A: Glossary

This Glossary lists the principal terms used in this Framework. Full definitions appear in §2. The forthcoming TLF Glossary at trustlayer.foundation/glossary maintains TLF-wide terminology and cross-references the ToIP Core Glossary for shared terms.

- **Acta Constitutiva**
- **Active Working Group Participant**
- **Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo**
- **Affiliated Entity**
- **ARIA**
- **Asamblea General**
- **Asociado**
- **Canonical Specification**
- **Comisario**
- **Community Group (CG)**
- **Consejo Directivo**
- **Contribution**
- **Contributor**
- **DCO / CLA**
- **Editor**
- **Federation**
- **Formal Recommendation**
- **Hotfix**
- **IPR Policy**
- **Lazy Consensus**
- **Liaison Co-Chair**
- **Normative**
- **Principal**
- **ROLA**
- **Rough Consensus**
- **Specification**
- **TSC**
- **TUNO Labs**
- **UCDM**
- **Working Group (WG)**

Appendix B: Statutory Compliance Calendar

This Appendix consolidates the statutory and operational deadlines applicable to TLF in its first three years of operation. The Compliance Cross-Reference companion document tracks status against each deadline.

Date / Period	Deadline / Milestone	Source / Framework Reference
Within 60 days of constitution (by May 19, 2026)	CLUNI filing (Clave Única de Inscripción al Registro Federal de las Organizaciones de la Sociedad Civil)	Acta Transitorio Primero; LFOSC
Q2-Q3 2026	Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo TLF-TUNO formal execution	§11.2.A; §1.6.3
Pre-publication (before circulating v1.5 externally)	Identification of 3-5 contacts for Code of Conduct external review pool	§4.8(a); Open Decisions sidepage B.1
By July 18, 2026 (120 days from constitution)	Publication of Governance Framework — v1.4 satisfies this deadline; v1.5 supersedes	Acta Transitorio Primero
Month 12 (March 2027)	Phase 1 TSC appointments completed per §4.3.1	§4.3; §4.3.1
By March 20, 2027	Admission of at least three (3) external Asociados	§1.6.3; §3.4.1
Q1 2027	Application for Donataria Autorizada status	§1.6.3; §3.7
Month 18 (September 2027)	ROLA template drafted and published; TUNO Labs ROLA execution; additional operator outreach	§11.2.B; §1.6.3
Month 24 (March 2028)	Phase 2 TSC community elections; Maturity Stage begins	§4.3; §1.6
Annually within first three months	Asamblea General de Asociados ordinary session; annual Maturity Report publication	Acta Artículo Décimo Sexto; §13.9

Appendix C: Changelog

v1.5 (May 2026)

Incorporates Secretario self-audit findings and TUNO contractual architecture clarification. Companion to W3C Agent Identity CG Charter Draft (separate document).

- **§3.4.1 NEW.** Asociado Admission Process with published criteria (5-year demonstrable experience, mission-relevance, structural independence, 24-month cooling-off), five nomination channels including 2+ Contributor petition and self-nomination with endorsement, 30-day public comment, community-accountability cascade ending in Comisario authority to convene extraordinary Asamblea per Acta Vigésimo Tercero (VI). TSC (not Consejo) sets revised timeline if commitment missed.
- **§4.3.1 NEW.** TSC Phase 1 Appointment Process with objective criteria (composition fit per §4.2, 12-month independence cooling-off, no family relationship, 5-year demonstrable standing, willingness/capacity), 14-day community preview period to W3C CG mailing list, optional independent advisory review, documented decisions, accountability cascade by analogy to §3.4.1(e).
- **§4.4 EXPANDED.** New §4.4(f) — Elected TSC Vice-Chair, elected by TSC (not Chair-appointed), with explicit authority under §4.4(f)(ii) to call formal votes when Chair has incorrectly determined consensus. Vice-Chair must satisfy enhanced independence requirements (no founding-family membership, no substantial Affiliated Entity relationship) — stronger than baseline §4.2.1(c).
- **§4.5.1 NEW.** TSC Consensus Determination Protocol: proposal posted to record before deliberation, documented concerns surfaced by Chair, explicit test for consensus with deliberate pause, acknowledgment of unresolved concerns distinguishing rough consensus from unanimous agreement, Vice-Chair check, right of dissent filed within 7 days.
- **§7.6 AMENDED.** Distinguishes (a) formal Community Group presence (governed by §7.8) from (b) informal contributor participation in external standards bodies (governed by §11.5 Cross-Network Engagement). Expanded list of external bodies of current or anticipated relevance.
- **§7.8 NEW.** Community Groups framework: §7.8.1 Definition and Role with scope clarification distinguishing CG relationships from regulator coordination; §7.8.2 TSC Obligations (30-day formal response to CG Recommendations, Liaison observer presence at TSC sessions); §7.8.3 Four-tier specification change communications (non-breaking 7d, breaking 14d comment, hotfix immediate, deprecation notices, standing briefing); §7.8.4 Liaison Co-Chair with Active Participant + structural independence eligibility, formation period grace, distinct from CG Chair when CG matures; §7.8.5 Meeting cadence and public record. Plural-aware: applies to current W3C Agent Identity CG and future CGs without amendment.
- **§11.2 RESTRUCTURED.** TUNO Labs relationship clarified as two distinct parallel contracts, not consecutive phases. §11.2.A Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo (technology development, TUNO

IP retention with open-access guarantees and reference-implementation open-source obligation, no fee/no rev share to TLF, contribution in kind, open-ended term, provisional language pending execution, Q2-Q3 2026 execution priority). §11.2.B ROLA (registry operator license, revenue share applied identically to all operators with specific rate established in ROLA template by month 18, substantially identical terms required as proof of non-exclusivity, qualification criteria, template publication by month 18, TUNO ROLA execution on identical terms, mandatory recusal of TUNO-affiliated Consejo members). Earlier drafts conflated the two contracts and referenced a specific revenue share figure at Framework level; v1.5 corrects both — contracts are separated, and the specific rate is properly relocated to the ROLA template per Consejo authority.

- **§1.6.3 UPDATED.** Cross-references to §3.4.1 and §4.3.1 added; ROLA timeline aligned with new §11.2.B architecture; Acuerdo Servicios added as separate Q2-Q3 2026 deliverable.
- **§13.9 EXPANDED.** Maturity Report requirements explicit: Asociado admission status, TSC composition status, federation status with ROLA execution, CG activity with Recommendations and TSC responses, specification activity, financial summary, Open Decisions status.
- **§2 EXPANDED.** New definitions: Acuerdo de Servicios y Desarrollo, Community Group, Formal Recommendation, Liaison Co-Chair, ROLA. Cross-references added to Asociado, TSC, Affiliated Entity, Active Working Group Participant (extended to include active CG participants).
- **Deferred to v1.5.1 or v1.6.** (i) §5.3 zombie-foundation trigger via W3C CG declaration of constructive abandonment — benefits from W3C CG and TSC input before adoption. (ii) §10.3 Formal Objection lightweight accountability process — modeled on W3C Formal Objection, benefits from TSC input on design.

v1.4 (May 2026)

Post-Consejo review. Incorporated 13 Consejo decisions: simplified §10 Dispute Resolution; consolidated §15 Data Protection statement; added §4.5 Vocal voice in TSC; added §4.6 quarterly TSC cadence; added §6.5 DNS sector recusal; added §7.4 grace period for implementations; added §7.5 UCDM WG pre-activation; added §8.5 IP Assignment timing; added §8.6 trademark policy framework; added §9.4 hotfix versioning; added §11.5 cross-network engagement; refined §13 transparency obligations; published with Open Decisions sidepage.

v1.3.1 (April 2026)

Post-Mike Rodenbaugh review. Hardened §5 Anti-Capture provisions; refined §8 IPR with patent non-assertion covenant and Active WG Participant extension; refined §11 Affiliated Entity provisions.

v1.3 (April 2026)

First Consejo-reviewed version. Established §3 Organizational Structure, §4 TSC, §5 Anti-Capture, §6 Conflicts of Interest, §7 Working Groups, §8 IPR, §9 Amendment, §10 Dispute Resolution, §11 Affiliated Entities, §12 Membership, §13 Transparency, §14 Amendment of Bylaws, §15 Data Protection.

v1.2 (March 2026)

Founder draft. Initial scaffolding.